

Martin Etmajer

TECHNOLOGY & PLATFORM LEADER

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“Simple things should be simple, complex things should be possible.” Alan Kay

Summary

Senior technology and platform leader with 15+ years of experience spanning software engineering, cloud-native architecture, platform product and engineering, and technology strategy. Proven track record in a regulated pharmaceutical environment: shaping the AI technology strategy, building and extending a cloud-native DevSecOps platform featuring reusable technology components for fast experimentation and GxP-compliant system go-lives, and developing strategic partnerships with third-party technology providers and collaborators.

Equally comfortable setting direction at the strategic level and driving hands-on execution, with a consistent focus on business and end-user value, simplicity, enabling modern engineering practices, and accelerating time-to-value. Deep expertise in cloud-native architecture, container orchestration, platform product and engineering, and governance.

Work Experience

Boehringer Ingelheim

Global

CTO OFFICE & ENTERPRISE ARCHITECTURE BOARD

Jul. 2025 - PRESENT

- Shaping *AI technology strategy* as part of a cross-functional core team. Designed an evaluation framework that brings together business and IT stakeholders in hands-on working groups to assess the applicability of AI across Boehringer's IT landscape, including the impact of agentic AI patterns on real LLM-based use cases, and deliver data-informed adoption roadmaps (ongoing).
- Designing a *supplier governance framework* that enables IT teams to integrate and operationalize third-party technologies faster and with less risk, spanning supplier requirements definition and contractual integration, training and enablement, and continuous monitoring (ongoing).
- Re-engineered Boehringer's *IT Change Management process* and automated what required *8 hours of manual effort per change*. Validated with selected partners including IT Computational Innovation, the first go-live covers *65% of all IT systems on Boehringer's DevSecOps platform*, projecting *7-figure annual labor savings*, with further rollouts planned.
- Hands-on developed a proof of concept for a fundamentally redesigned *GxP computer system validation approach* at Boehringer, reducing compliance efforts by *up to 90%*. Secured approval from an external auditor in collaboration with Global Quality.

CIO ADVISORY

Oct. 2024 - PRESENT

HEAD OF IT PLATFORM PRODUCT & ENGINEERING

Oct. 2022 - Dec. 2025

- Positioned Boehringer's *DevSecOps platform* as a strategic product enabling business and IT teams to turn ideas into compliant, production-ready solutions: expanded its scope to include a *reusable components marketplace*, *management plane*, *unified UX*, and address new users including data engineers, data analysts, data scientists, and AI/ML engineers, accelerating time-to-market for digital initiatives.
- Built a *high-performing remote team of 15* through structured goal-setting, coaching, and continuous improvement, delivering *4x more major releases per year*, *30x improved validation testing efficiency*, and reducing technical onboarding from *30 days to a few hours*.
- Drove platform adoption into *high-criticality GxP-regulated environments* following a risk-based approach to ensure responsible entry, enabling regulated areas to leverage modern DevSecOps practices and reduce delivery times from *weeks to hours*.
- Applied *Team Topologies* principles to design platform, enabling, and stream-aligned team interactions, defining self-service interfaces, enablement paths, and collaboration boundaries to optimize flow.

CHIEF IT PLATFORMS ENTERPRISE ARCHITECT & IT CAPABILITY LEAD

Apr. 2019 - Sept. 2022

- Led the *target architecture* definition for a strategic, *cloud-native DevSecOps platform* and unified delivery process at the heart of IT strategy, serving diverse users, including software engineers, testers, and compliance experts, balancing flexibility with hard compliance requirements.
- Drove the *convergence of Boehringer's IT standards*, including platform technologies, into this *GxP-compliant delivery process*, giving teams a *single path from idea to production*, enabling fast experimentation, rapid feedback cycles, and shorter time-to-value for all new systems.
- Co-founded the *IT Engineering Academy* to promote engineering best practices across the user base through content and hands-on training. Founded a *conference* to evangelize the platform and drive adoption across business and IT, reaching *800+ attendees* by its third edition.

- Designed and facilitated a *one-week innovation workshop* for the newly founded *Boehringer IT Cloud Center of Excellence of 15*, establishing the team's vision, strategy, and operating model based on *Team Topologies* principles, accelerating time-to-first-MVP.
- Spearheaded the development of a *LEGO-esque architecture of small, reusable, and composable infrastructure-as-code building blocks* using open-source technology, including *Ansible and Terraform*, to facilitate self-service, improve quality, and decrease time-to-market.
- Coached the team in adopting *Agile, Lean, and UX practices* to establish a user-centric delivery culture.

GetCloudnative

Linz, Austria

FOUNDER & PRINCIPAL CONSULTANT

May 2018 - Sep. 2019

- Provided *cloud-native architecture and Agile transformation* consulting. Engagement at *Boehringer Ingelheim* led to a permanent senior role.

Dynatrace

Linz, Austria

SENIOR TECHNOLOGY STRATEGIST/LEAD AT INNOVATION LAB

Mar. 2014 - Feb. 2018

- Led strategic innovation initiatives to tame complexity in some of the world's largest software systems at a *multi-year consecutive Gartner Magic Quadrant leader*, reporting directly to *C-level leadership*.
- Developed integrations for Dynatrace into technologies such as *Ansible, Chef, Docker, Cloud Foundry, and Red Hat OpenShift*, many of which achieved *partner status* with the respective vendors. Promoted to the global customer base to simplify automation and accelerate Dynatrace adoption. Released as *open source* on GitHub and later scaled into the core Dynatrace organization.
- Partnered with *Fortune 1000* customers and industry analysts at *Gartner and Forrester* to translate customer needs and market trends into product direction. Supported pre-sales engagements through on-site technical workshops at enterprise customers across EMEA. Developed technology partnerships and executed joint go-to-market strategies with ISVs *Opscode and Red Hat*, and evangelized *AI-driven observability* to international Dynatrace user groups and global C-level audiences.
- Designed and scaled a *technical enablement program* for Dynatrace's global sales engineering community. Shared expertise via *DevOps.com*, international meetup groups, and technology conferences including *DevOps Days Berlin, Kubernetes NYC, and Red Hat Summit Boston*.

Smarter Ecommerce

Linz, Austria

SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER

Sep. 2011 - Jan. 2014

- Developed software products in *automated Pay-Per-Click advertising*, focused on *data engineering, visualization, and data storytelling*.
- Drove engineering culture through regular *tech talks*, surfacing emerging trends and framing their practical applicability for the team.

GitHub

OPEN SOURCE CONTRIBUTOR AND MAINTAINER

May 2010 - PRESENT

- Created *dataseries.js*, a JavaScript library for generating arbitrary time series data to accelerate data visualization prototyping workflows.
- Co-maintained *terraform-docs*, a tool that transforms Terraform configurations into human-readable documentation and continuous delivery pipeline-ready output formats. The project grew into a *community standard*, reaching *4,000+ GitHub Stars and 500+ Forks* by April 2024.
- Contributed to a range of high-profile open-source projects, including *d3js.org, Homebrew, Kubernetes, kubicorn, and Linux-HA*.

StreamUnlimited

Vienna, Austria

SYSTEMS AND SOFTWARE ARCHITECT

Jul. 2006 - Jul. 2011

- Led requirements elicitation, architecture, and engineering for global enterprise customers in the *automotive, consumer electronics, and healthcare industries*, including *Bang & Olufsen, Hitachi, and Philips Speech Processing*.
- Co-architected a *high-availability computation cluster* for Springer Publishing using *Linux-HA*, hosting a recommender system that combined high-performance search engines, database query design, and machine learning to deliver personalized content at scale.
- Introduced *Continuous Integration* practices to the organization's software development lifecycle, improving software quality and reducing reliance on manual testing.

Technical Skills

Cloud-native architecture (Kubernetes, OpenShift, AWS), infrastructure-as-code (Terraform, Ansible), CI/CD, container orchestration; Groovy, Bash, JavaScript, Git. Currently extending into Python, machine learning, and data engineering; prompt engineering, LLM APIs, agentic AI patterns, and AI evaluation frameworks.

Training & Certifications

- 2026 Machine Learning, DeepLearning.AI and Stanford University (ongoing)
- 2026 Data Engineering, DeepLearning.AI and Amazon Web Services (ongoing)
- 2026 Agentic AI, DeepLearning.AI
- 2026 Claude, Anthropic Academy
- 2019 Train the Trainer - Training and Workshop Facilitation Bootcamp, Indiálogo, Barcelona

Selected Public Speaking & Publications

- 2018 From Fragile to Agile: Innovating Cloud Service Delivery at a Global Enterprise, Agile Tour Vienna
- 2017 Challenges in a Microservices Age: Monitoring, Logging and Tracing on OpenShift, Red Hat Summit Boston
- 2015 Agile Infrastructure: Because your Infrastructure Deserves Tests, Too, DevOps.com
- 2015 Test-Driven Infrastructure with Ansible, Test Kitchen, Serverspec and RSpec, DevOps Days Berlin

Languages

German Native proficiency

English Full professional proficiency

Education

Vienna University of Technology

Vienna, Austria

MSC. IN COMPUTER ENGINEERING (GRADUATED WITH HONORS)

Oct. 2004 - Feb. 2011

Recommendations

Markus Schümmelfeder

Apr. 2026

CHIEF INFORMATION OFFICER, BOEHRINGER INGELHEIM

"I have known and worked with Martin for several years in my role as CIO at Boehringer Ingelheim. What sets Martin apart is his ability to bridge strategy and execution. He brings broad technical knowledge that allows him to quickly assess a situation, propose a solution, and build the team to deliver it. I have met many architects who can analyze and explain, but very few who also make things happen. Martin is one of them. Under his leadership, Boehringer's DevSecOps platform grew from an engineering tool into a strategic capability adopted across IT and 18 business areas, redefining how teams build and deliver software using a common delivery process. Martin's impact extends well beyond his own domain. He re-engineered our IT Change Management process by earning the trust of the team that owns it, working through their concerns with hard facts and patience. Martin combines deep technical expertise with a sense for where improvement matters most, the ability to win people over, and the persistence to see it through in a complex environment. I recommend him without reservation."

Günter Schramm

Aug. 2018

DIRECTOR TECHNICAL CUSTOMER SUPPORT, DYNATRACE

"I had the pleasure to work with Martin during his time at Dynatrace. My team regularly consulted with him on business-relevant cloud-native and microservices technology, such as Red Hat OpenShift and Kubernetes. Together with Martin, we've developed a training program to help our globally distributed teams embrace these emerging technologies – and knowing how much professionalism Martin puts into his work, it comes as no surprise to me that his training concepts and material have remained in high demand ever since. Martin has this rare ability to understand complex technology in all its depth, and explain it to others in a simple and understandable way. It's that combination that makes him an extraordinary enabler and technology evangelist."

Dr. Peter Putz

Feb. 2018

OPERATIONS LEAD, DYNATRACE INNOVATION LAB (PREVIOUSLY A SENIOR MANAGER, NASA)

"While working as a Senior Technology Strategist with the Dynatrace Innovation Lab Martin distinguished himself as a technical visionary and business strategist. As an outstanding expert in CI/CD and cloud technologies he was at the forefront of scouting, assessing and adopting rapidly emerging technologies to advance the Dynatrace industry leading monitoring solution. He was key in establishing strategic alliances with global cloud providers and successfully lead go-to-market efforts by bringing together cross-functional and globally distributed teams. His diligence and keen sense of technological advancements made him a well respected player within the cloud community."